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Name of faculty: Rajesh Kumar

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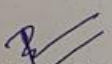
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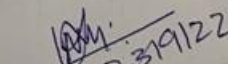
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Notes By: - RAJESH KUMAR (Asst. Prof, EE Department)

Benefits of effective writing skills for engineering student

The second half of the 20th century saw a significant rise of demand for qualified engineers, mostly because after the World War II there was a lot to be rebuilt but also science and technology started to develop rapidly. Large companies, often owned by people that weren't engineers, but rich investors, needed specialists that could communicate in a way that was easy to understand. The late 60's introduced technical writing which became one of the essential soft skills for every aspiring engineer. The reasons why writing is important nowadays vary and hold value to both engineers and their companies. In this article, we will discuss some of the major benefits that good writing skills hold for engineers.

1. The Better Prospect of Landing a Job

degrees in the world are sometimes not enough to get a job if you are not able to present yourself as a valuable asset. Good writing skills can help you create a compelling cover letter and resume that will point out all of your All the skills and clarify your value to that particular company. Hiring experts claim that it takes no longer than three minutes to determine if the cover letter is worthy of consideration and writing style is one of the key factors that form their decision.

2. Promote Yourself Internationally

Blogging is arguably the best way to represent your achievements and opinions to people from all over the world. As a striving engineer, you should consider letting everyone know what you stand for and what you plan to do with the skills you possess. To be successful at blogging you should aim for a broad audience which means communicating in a manner that is easy to understand, especially if engineering is nothing more than a mere interest of the reader. Proper spelling and grammar are of the utmost importance for each post so, while you develop your writing skills, consider hiring a proofreading service to check your work before publishing.

3. Communication with Management

It's not easy to explain the reasons why a certain project should be placed on hold or pushed forward with additional funds if you are not able to present your case so that people who are not experts in your field could understand what you are talking about. Therefore, it's important to learn how to create written content that will bring your arguments closer to company management. Presentations of elaborate technical data alone won't do you much good, and therefore endanger your position and even your job security.

Furthermore, explaining new ideas to your boss would be much easier if you are able to present them in a meaningful form that would elaborate all of the benefits your project brings to the company. Sometimes the complexity of your idea could not be read by non-technical personnel without proper wording that is

easy to understand. Surely, you can always go online and search for academic writing help, but that won't do you much good in the long run; eventually, you will have to master the skill for your own sake.

on the company size, the number of employees, and team member availability, it will be your job to create technical documentation, specifications, system requirements, manuals, warranty restrictions, and other parts of product documentation intended for third-party individuals, users, or technical support. This is where your writing skills are put to the test because you have to create documentation that shows technical aspects of a product or service that are easy to understand and follow certain industry standards.

In addition, a technical documentation engineer is a position that pays well, according to some resources, the starting salary for this position revolves around \$50k per year.

4. Communication with Different Divisions in the Company

Engineers are often required to work closely with various departments in the company such as sales, marketing, and other divisions that are not inhabited by engineers and technical staff. Much of the internal communication goes via emails so the ability to understand each other's messages is of paramount importance. If the departments are not communicating properly the whole project is in danger. Good writing skills allow you to create clear emails that are easy to understand, which makes the job easier for other members of the company. If an engineer doesn't explain all of the significant aspects of the product, the marketing won't be able to create a good strategy, the sales team could select the wrong price, and the company would suffer the consequences.

Conclusion

Writing is an important soft skill that everyone, including engineers, should consider developing for the betterment of their careers. Engineers, more than others, have the need for good writing skills as they allow simplification of complex scientific terms and data. This way, engineers can bring their aspirations and creativity closer to regular people who are in dire need of products and services crafted by the people of math and numbers.

Ways to improve writing skills

Many people underestimate the importance of having excellent writing skills. Read on to learn more about how you facilitate the improvement of what is arguably one of the most indispensable skills to have; written communication!

Believe it or not, writing, apart from the spoken word, is one of the world's oldest forms of communication that still exists today. Think about it; while we may no longer invest time in sending letters to one another, our daily communication is always accompanied by some form of writing, be it in text messages, daily emails, or posts you make on your social media accounts.

In the university space, academic writing is a whole other ball game and often takes on a very different form to other types of writing out there, but the simple fact is that you cannot achieve a high level of college writing if you don't know how to improve your basic writing skills!

Even if your chosen career path doesn't necessarily involve writing as a form of income, being able to communicate effectively is incredibly important to ensure success in today's competitive international job market. Think about email-writing; it hardly looks professional if you send an email to your boss or colleague that isn't well thought-out and contains many errors.

Here are 6 simple tips to improve your writing skills!

1. Make Writing a Daily

Practice really does make perfect! If you compare writing to a skill like cooking, or even playing a sport, you cannot expect to improve if you don't practice – it's like expecting to become a pro football player after one practice with your team.

Try to set yourself daily writing exercises – they need not be long-winded and time-consuming, even just committing yourself to writing a paragraph a day is enough! You can even partner up with someone else who also wants to improve their writing skills and read each other's paragraphs to see where changes need to be made.

2. Read, Read, and Read Some More!

We learn best by example, and gaining writing skills is no exception to this rule. When we read, we learn how other people write to convey their messages in the best way possible, and we start to adapt our writing styles to those that we resonate most with.

Incorporate daily reading into your writing exercises; maybe even make your practice paragraph a review or summary of what you read that day, taking different elements of the author's writing style to develop your own voice.

3. Be Succinct

Try not to use any complicated, long words in your writing. They often confuse the reader and make them disinterested in what you have to say. Keep your sentences short. Never over-use filler words like “very”, “really”, “just”, etc.

They tend to make sentences long and unnecessarily take up your reader's cognitive space.

4. Never Underestimate the Importance of a Thorough Editing Session

Editing is a part of the writing process that is completely underrated and that is frequently overlooked. Errors in your writing are likely to take attention away from the message you are trying to convey and decrease your reader's trust in your viability as a writer.

The human brain often overlooks certain small errors during the proofreading process, so using an online editing tool, like Grammarly, comes highly recommended.

5. Develop a Clear Message

There is nothing more frustrating than a piece of writing that doesn't get straight to the point. Think about what you want to say, what message you want your reader to take away with them, and make sure that that you make this message clear from the very beginning.

It is also important to think about your audience; what do they want to hear, and how would they like it to be conveyed? Do you need to take on a formal, or a more informal tone? Would using humour help develop your message, or should you get straight to the point in a more businesslike fashion?

These are important considerations that need to be taken into account.

before you even begin the writing process.

6. Sit Down and Write!

Sometimes the most difficult step in the writing process is the act of actually sitting down and getting the writing done. By this point, you should have a clear plan of what you want to say, and a general idea of how you want to say it.

It may seem daunting, but remember that the hard work is now done! All you need to do is convince yourself that you are capable (which you are), sit down in front of your notebook or computer, and execute your communication!

The Art of Condensation: Paragraph Writing

The Art of Condensation

The art of condensation is the process to make any piece of writing precise by omitting unnecessary elements these art of condensation in creative writing is synonymous with precise writing.

According to Collins dictionary:

“To make a precis of a given passes is to extract its main points and express them clearly.”

According to Oxford dictionary

“A concise or abridged statement a summary or abstract.”

In Fact precis or the art of condensation is just a straight forward statement of the bare facts without any unnecessary trimming that means it must be able to stand alone and make a complete sense.”
characteristics of art of condensation.

Characteristics of art of condensation

We should remember 5 characteristics of art of condensation.

1. Completeness
2. compactness
3. conciseness
4. Clarity
5. Coherence

1. **Completeness:** the precise must have the essential contents of the original passage without omitting any important fact.

2. **Compactness:** all the ideas we produced from the original document should form compactness. The words end sentence is should not convey a sense of unity with each other.

3. **Conciseness:** brevity is the sense of precis. It is achieved by avoiding repetitions and omitting ornamental phrases etc. But brevity should not be achieved at the cost of clarity. There should be economy of words but not of ideas.

4. **Clarity:** the precis should have clarity of expressions. This can be achieved by getting rid of redundancy. It should be in the language which could be understood by everyone.

5. **Coherence:** the main theme should run through the sentences like the string of a necklace. All the sentences and ideas in a precis should follow one after other in unbreakable chain. They should

follow our natural order of development. One sentence should suggest the next and so on. Above all the sentences should not be like a collection of disjointed sentences, but well connected one.

Paragraph Writing (Progression of Thoughts In paragraph writing)

A paragraph is a group of related sentences that support one main idea. In general, paragraphs consist of three parts: the topic sentence, body sentences, and the concluding or the bridge sentence to the next paragraph or section. Paragraphs show where the subdivisions of a research paper begin and end and, thus, help the reader see the organization of the essay and grasp its main points.

Importance of Constructing Good Paragraphs

Paragraphs are the building blocks of papers. Without well-written paragraphs that flow logically from one idea to the next and that inform and help support in some meaningful way the central research problem being investigated, your paper will not be viewed as credible and, well, you'll probably receive a poor grade.

Here are some suggestions for troubleshooting common problems associated with developing paragraphs:

1. **The paragraph has no controlling idea.** Imagine each paragraph as having three general layers of text. The core content is in the middle. It includes all the evidence you need to make the point. However, this evidence needs to be introduced by a topic sentence in some way or your readers don't know what to do with all the evidence you have given them. Therefore, the beginning of the paragraph explains the controlling idea of the paragraph. The last part of the paragraph tells the reader how the paragraph relates to the broader argument and often provides a transition to the next idea. Once you have mastered the use of topic sentences, you may decide that the topic sentence for a particular paragraph really should not be the first sentence of the paragraph. This is fine—the topic sentence can actually go at the beginning, middle, or end of a paragraph; what's important is that it is there to inform readers what the main idea of the paragraph is and how it relates back to the broader thesis of your paper.
2. **The paragraph has more than one controlling idea.** This is the most common reason why a paragraph is too long. If a paragraph is more than a page long, it likely contains more than one controlling idea. In this case, consider eliminating sentences that relate to the second idea, with the thought that maybe they don't really inform and help support the central research problem, or split the paragraph into two or more paragraphs, each with only one controlling idea.
3. **Transitions are needed within the paragraph.** You are probably familiar with the idea that transitions may be needed between paragraphs or sections in a paper. Sometimes they are also helpful within the body of a single paragraph. Within a paragraph, transitions are often single words or short phrases that help to establish relationships between ideas and to create a logical progression of those ideas in a paragraph. This is especially true within paragraphs that discuss multiple examples or discuss complex ideas, issues, or concepts.

Structure and Writing Style

I. General Structure

Most paragraphs in an essay parallel the general three-part structure of each section of a research paper and, by extension, the overall research paper, with an introduction, a body that includes facts and analysis, and a conclusion. You can see this structure in paragraphs whether they are narrating, describing, comparing, contrasting, or analyzing information. Each part of the paragraph plays an important role in communicating the meaning you intend to convey to the reader.

Introduction: the first section of a paragraph; should include the topic sentence and any other sentences at the beginning of the paragraph that give background information or provide a transition.

Body: follows the introduction; discusses the controlling idea, using facts, arguments, analysis, examples, and other information.

Conclusion: the final section; summarizes the connections between the information discussed in the body of the paragraph and the paragraph's controlling idea. For long paragraphs, you may also want to include a bridge sentence that introduces the next paragraph or section of the paper. In some instances, the bridge sentence can be written in the form of a question. However, use this rhetorical device sparingly, otherwise, ending a lot of paragraphs with a question to lead into the next paragraph sounds cumbersome.

NOTE: This general structure does not imply that you should not be creative in your writing. Arranging where each element goes in a paragraph can make a paper more engaging for the reader. However, do not be too creative in experimenting with the narrative flow of paragraphs. To do so may distract from the main arguments of your research and weaken the quality of your academic writing.

II. Development and Organization

This is the "controlling idea," or the thesis statement from which you compose the remainder of the paragraph. In other words, your paragraphs should remind your reader that there is a recurrent relationship between your controlling idea and the information in each paragraph. The research problem functions like a seed from which your paper, and your ideas, will grow. The whole process of paragraph development is an organic one—a natural progression from a seed idea to a full-blown research study where there are direct, familial relationships in the paper between all of your controlling ideas and the paragraphs which derive from them.

There are many techniques for brainstorming but, whichever one you choose, this stage of paragraph development cannot be skipped because it lays a foundation for developing a set of paragraphs [representing a section of your paper] that describes a specific element of your overall analysis. Each section is described further in this writing guide.

Given these factors, every paragraph in a paper should be :

- **Unified**—All of the sentences in a single paragraph should be related to a single controlling idea [often expressed in the topic sentence of the paragraph].
- **Clearly related to the research problem**—The sentences should all refer to the central idea, or the thesis, of the paper.
- **Coherent**—The sentences should be arranged in a logical manner and should follow a definite plan for development.
- **Well-developed**—Every idea discussed in the paragraph should be adequately explained and supported through evidence and details that work together to explain the paragraph's controlling idea.

There are many different ways you can organize a paragraph:

However, the organization you choose will depend on the controlling idea of the paragraph. Ways to organize a paragraph in academic writing include:

- **Narrative:** Tell a story. Go chronologically, from start to finish.
- **Descriptive:** Provide specific details about what something looks or feels like. Organize spatially, in order of appearance, or by topic
- **Process:** Explain step by step how something works. Perhaps follow a sequence—first, second, third.
- **Classification:** Separate into groups or explain the various parts of a topic.
- **Illustrative:** Give examples and explain how those examples prove your point.

The Thought Building in Paragraph

The conventional way of speaking and writing is in topics; that is, in paragraphs developed. A topic is a particular assertion made of a subject. For example, take the term "war" and the statement, "War is destructive to human life": "war" is the subject; "is destructive to human life" is the topic—the particular thing said about the subject. A topic, therefore, is always a thought; the development of it, a paragraph.

This is a practical point of view to take of a paragraph, for by stressing it, it is possible to set forth a method of teaching thought- building that is designed to accomplish the following purposes:

- (1) To give the pupils mastery over the elementary principles and processes of thought-building;
- (2) To teach them to interpret, evaluate, and relate their experiences;
- (3) To bring them face to face with the mechanics and principles of paragraph-writing in such a way that they shall master them naturally; and
- (4) To lead the pupils into self-cultivation in English. The devices that are used are intended to relate the whole process, as much as is possible, to the experiences of the pupils.

In order to accomplish the foregoing purposes economically and efficiently, pupils must be required to speak and write paragraphs out of their own experiences. The general method of procedure is as follows:

1. Formulate a working thought or belief.
2. Call to mind and tabulate all the ideas, thoughts, facts, experiences, illustrations, analogies, and so on, that relate to the central purpose of the paragraph.
3. Examine these materials in the light of the common element that must run through all that are chosen, in order to secure unity.
4. Choose only the best materials; compare them in order to determine, first, how to group them; secondly, in what sequence and proportion to set forth the sentences and groups of sentences.
5. Having determined what method of paragraph development is best suited to the materials and purposes, set forth the working thought in terms of a fitting topic statement.
6. Amplify the topic statement, and in the meantime give attention to the mechanics and principles of writing, punctuation etc.

Formal and Informal Letters

Letters are a form of verbal and written communication, which contains information or message, send by one party to another, to convey the message. It is sent by one party to another, to provide certain important information. There are two types of letters, i.e. formal letters and informal letters. The **formal letter** is written for business or professional purposes with a specific objective in mind. It uses simple language, that can be easy to read and interpret.

On the contrary, **informal letters** are written to friends and relative for personal communication and uses a casual or an emotional tone. The article excerpt presents you all the important differences between formal and informal letters in a detailed manner.

Comparison Chart between Formal and Informal Letters:

BASIS FOR COMPARISON	FORMAL LETTER	INFORMAL LETTER
Meaning	A formal letter is a letter, written in formal language, in the stipulated format, for official purpose.	A letter written in an friendly manner, to someone you are familiar with, is called informal letter.
Objective	Professional Communication	Personal Communication
Format	Written in prescribed format only.	No prescribed format.
Written in	First person - Business letters, third person - others.	First, second or third person.
Written to	Business, college/institute, employer, organizations, etc.	Friends, family, acquaintances etc.
Voice	Passive	Active
Sentences	Long and complex	Short and simple
Size	Concise	Large or concise
Contractions and Abbreviations	Avoided	Used

Definition of Formal Letters

A formal letter is any letter written in the professional language, with a prescribed format for a formal purpose, i.e. it can be a recommendation letter, enquiry letter, complaint letter, cover letter and so on. All business letters are formal, but vice versa is not possible. Such letters are used for a variety of reasons like a formal invitation, proposal, reference, making a complaint or inquiry, applying for a job. While writing a formal letter one should keep in mind the following things:

- It should be in specified format.
- It should avoid the use of unnecessary words.
- It should be straight to the point.
- It should be relevant and objective.
- It should be complex and thorough.
- It should be polite, even if it is a complaint letter.
- It should be free from any mistakes, i.e. grammatical or spelling.

Definition of Informal Letters

An informal letter is a letter written to someone; we know fairly well. The letter can be used for some reasons like conveying message, news, giving advice, congratulate recipient, request information, asking questions, etc. It is a personal letter, written to whom you are familiar with, like friends, siblings, parents or any other closed one. There is no specific format prescribed for writing this letter.

While writing an informal letter, one can afford to be friendly, and make use personal or emotional tone. Slang or colloquial terms, codes, abbreviations, etc. can also be used at the time of writing it, depending on the familiarity with the recipient.

Key Differences Between Formal and Informal Letter

The significant points of difference between formal and informal letters are discussed as under:

1. A formal letter is one, written in formal language, in the stipulated format, for official purpose. A letter is said to be informal when it is written in a friendly manner, to someone you are familiar with.
2. Formal letters are written for official or professional communication. On the other hand, informal letters are used for casual or personal communication.
3. There is a manner prescribed for writing formal letters. As opposed to informal communication, which does not follow any format.
4. Formal letters are usually written in the third person, however, for business letters, first person is used. On the contrary, informal letters are written in first, second and third person.
5. Formal letters are used for writing letters to business, i.e. partners, suppliers, customers, clients, etc, college or institute, employer, professionals, etc. As against this, we use informal letters for writing letters to friends, relatives, acquaintance, etc.
6. While writing formal letters, we use passive voice. Conversely, an active and imperative voice is used.

7. The sentences we use at the time of writing a formal letter are, long and complex. Unlike an informal letter, where we use short and simple sentences which are easy to interpret.
8. The size of a formal letter should be concise; that does not include irrelevant matter. In contrast, the informal letter can be concise or large.
9. Formal letters do not include contraction like (didn't, can't) and abbreviations rather it uses full forms. As compared to informal letters, which makes use of contraction, abbreviation, idioms, phrasal verbs and even slang and colloquial terms.

Conclusion

So, before start writing letter, first of all, you should identify, who is your recipient? If you are having a professional relationship with the recipient, then you should go for a formal letter, whereas if the recipient is someone very close to you or you know the recipient well, then the informal letter is the right choice for you.